

GAURAV DESAI

Risk, compliance & technology

+41 79 391 89 98

Zurich Switzerland

gauravdesai111@gmail.com

Professional summary

Director at UBS driving the technical roadmap for an AI-driven platform for ethical AI risk assessment under the EU AI Act. Combines over a decade of financial services leadership in compliance, AML, and model validation with hands-on technical expertise in AI-assisted risk assessment. Skilled at leading cross-functional teams to build and validate sophisticated AI-driven solutions, bridging regulatory insight with practical technology implementation to enhance risk management and operational effectiveness.

Digital Presence

LinkedIn : [gauravkdesai](#)
GitHub : [gauravkdesai](#)
Website : [gaurav-desai.com](#)

Education

Master Of Information And Data Science
UC Berkeley School Of Information - 08/2020

Bachelor In Engineering: Information Technology
Mumbai University - Mumbai, 06/2006

Work history

DATA ETHICS AND TRUSTWORTHY AI SPECIALIST, 07/2025 - Current
UBS, Zurich

- Evaluate ethical and AI risk for models
- Driving the technical roadmap for an AI-driven platform that enables ethical AI risk assessment under the EU AI Act framework.

HEAD OF TRANSACTION MONITORING AND SURVEILLANCE MODEL VALIDATION, 02/2023 - 07/2025
UBS, Zurich

- Led AML transaction monitoring models validation team
- Spearheaded validation of cybersecurity and fraud detection models
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to ensure compliance with regulatory standards, driving proactive risk management strategies

MODEL VALIDATION LEAD, COMPLIANCE MODELS, 05/2020 - 02/2023
UBS, Mumbai

- Led projects to assess model risk using qualitative and quantitative methods, producing comprehensive validation reports, enhancing risk management strategies

TECH LEAD, 08/2017 - 05/2020
UBS, Mumbai

- Lead a team supporting regulatory stress calculations in Credit Risk. Responsible for architectural decisions, designs and work allocation in addition to being Scrum Master and

Individual contributor. Tech Stack : Java, Oracle, Unix, Autosys, TeamCity, GitHub Tools: IntelliJ, Toad, Jira

TEAM LEAD – MARKET DATA AND PNL EXPLAINS, 06/2010 - 08/2017

JPMorgan Chase & Co., Mumbai

- Lead a team responsible to manage Market and Reference data repository for Credit Risk calculations. Also managed application that explains profit and loss for end of day positions in Credit Risk trades. Tech Stack : Java, Sybase, Unix Tools : IntelliJ, Jenkins, BitBucket

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER, 10/2006 - 06/2010

Patni Computer Systems, Mumbai, London

- Individual Contributor Tech Stack : Java, Oracle, Unix, Swing, JSP, Servlet Tools : WSAD, Oracle Developer

CERTIFICATIONS

Oxford AI Ethics, Regulation and Compliance Programme from Saïd Business School, University of Oxford , 07/2025

CQF , 04/2022

Skills

Ethical AI Risk Management

Hands on Coding

Model Risk Management

Ethical AI Risk Management